PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY
ISSUED
DATE: NOV 16 2021
SIGNATURE:

Office of the University President

MEMORANDUM
No. 402 s. 2021

TO : **UNIVERSITY OFFICIALS**
TEACHING PERSONNEL
NON-TEACHING PERSONNEL
ALL CONCERNED

FROM: **OFFICE OF THE UNIVERSITY PRESIDENT**

DATE : **NOVEMBER 15, 2021**

RE : **RESOLUTIONS PASSED DURING THE 82ND REGULAR BOARD OF REGENTS MEETING HELD ON NOVEMBER 11, 2021 VIA ZOOM**

This is to inform the entire PSU Community of the decisions made by the PSU Governing Board during their 82nd Regular Board of Regents Meeting held on November 11, 2021 via Zoom. To wit:

RESOLUTIONS	OFFICE/ PERSON/S CONCERNED
Resolution No. 48, s. 2021 A resolution approving the minutes of the 81st Regular Board of Regents Meeting held on June 23, 2021 via Zoom, provided that corrections be submitted to the Board Secretary within ten (10) working days after the meeting and that the corrected minutes should be re-appended in the next Board meeting.	▪ Office of the President ▪ Board Secretary ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 49, s. 2021 A resolution approving the offering of BS Biology major in Conservation and Restoration Ecology at Partido State University – Caramoan Campus effective AY 2021 -2022, subject to compliance with pertinent CHED issuances and applicable government rules and laws.	▪ VPAA ▪ Dr. Clores ▪ Caramoan Campus ▪ University Registrar's Office ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 50, s. 2021 A resolution approving the Inclusion of Literacy Training Service (LTS) as one of the components of NSTP in the Program of Studies effective AY 2021-2022, subject to compliance with pertinent CHED issuances and applicable government rules and laws.	▪ VPAA ▪ Dr. Caballero ▪ NSTP Office ▪ University Registrar's Office ▪ Deans ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 51, s. 2021 A resolution approving the revision of the Program the Program Objectives of the BS Agribusiness Program, subject to compliance with applicable CHED issuances and directives from regulatory bodies.	▪ VPAA ▪ Dr. Paladan ▪ Salogon Campus ▪ All concerned

Resolution No. 52, s. 2021 A resolution approving proposed Establishment of the University Social Science Cluster, subject to compliance with applicable CHED issuances.	▪ VPAA ▪ Dr. Gumba ▪ SS Cluster ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 53, s. 2021 A resolution approving the proposal entitled, "Institutionalizing a Process for Mentored Graduate Thesis and Dissertation", subject to compliance with pertinent CHED requirements and applicable existing laws.	▪ VPAA ▪ School of Graduate Studies ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 54, s. 2021 A resolution approving the Establishment of Partido State University Research Ethics Committee (PSUREC), subject to compliance with pertinent government issuances.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Director ▪ Mr. Baldo ▪ Deans ▪ Faculty Researchers ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 55, s. 2021 A resolution approving the proposed Establishment of Partido State University Water Resources Research Center, subject to the usual government accounting and auditing procedures, and compliance with applicable issuances from regulatory bodies.	▪ VPREKM ▪ VPAA ▪ Engr. Padayao ▪ CET ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 56, s. 2021 A resolution approving the proposal entitled, "Incentivizing PSU RDE Monitoring Team", subject to availability of funds and the usual government accounting and auditing rules.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Office ▪ Deans ▪ Finance Division ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 57, s. 2021 A resolution approving the Establishment of Partido State University Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC), provided it is compliant with the pertinent issuances from the Bureau of Animal Industry of the Department of Agriculture, DBM, COA, CHED, and other regulatory bodies.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Office ▪ Mr. Garbeles ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 58, s. 2021 A resolution approving the proposal entitled, "Guidelines for Research and Extension Proposals with Duration and Budget Ceiling", subject to the usual government accounting and auditing rules.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Office ▪ Extension Services Office ▪ Deans ▪ Faculty ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 59, s. 2021 A resolution approving the appointment of Engr. Joel P. Sadol as Associate Professor II (SG 20) effective upon approval by the Board, subject to compliance with pertinent Civil Service rules and regulations, DBM issuances, COA memorandum circulars, and other existing laws.	▪ VPAA ▪ VPAF ▪ HRMO ▪ Finance Division ▪ Deans ▪ All concerned

Resolution No. 60, s. 2021

A resolution confirming the appointment of the following teaching and non-teaching personnel, subject to compliance with pertinent Civil Service rules and regulations, DBM issuances, COA memorandum circulars, and other existing laws. To wit:

Name	Position & SG	Effectivity	Status
a. Lito A. Begonia	Instructor I (SG 12)	Sept. 1, 2021	Permanent
b. May C. Manla	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug. 2, 2021	Permanent
c. Anton A. Romero	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug. 2, 2021	Permanent
d. Vasil A. Victoria, PhD	Asst. Prof. III (SG 17)	*	Permanent
e. Gina B. Alcoriza, DBA	Asst. Prof. III (SG 17)	Aug. 16, 2021	Permanent
f. Carlo Gabriel R. Abante	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug. 2, 2021	Temporary
g. Divina P. Chica	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug. 2, 2021	Temporary
h. Shaira M. Mendones	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug. 2, 2021	Temporary
i. Gilbert L. Pado	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug. 2, 2021	Temporary
j. Diana Rose R. Pesimo	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug. 2, 2021	Temporary
k. Kevin Neil G. Tan	Instructor I (SG 12)	Aug.2, 2021	Temporary
l. Elaine Grace L. Bombase	Accountant II (SG 16)	*	Permanent
m. Monette A. Espia	Admin. Officer II (SG 11)	*	Permanent
n. Richard B. Pascor	Security Guard III (SG 08)	*	Permanent

* Effective upon submission of the required documents.

- VPAA
- VPAF
- HRMO
- Finance Division
- Deans
- Appointees
- All concerned

Resolution No. 61, s. 2021

A resolution confirming the Scholarship Contract of the following permanent teaching and non-teaching personnel, subject to compliance with the scholarship guidelines approved by the Board, and pertinent issuances from the granting institutions, CHED, CSC, DBM and COA. To wit:

Name	Degree	School	Duration	Scholarship
a. Garry P. Dacillo	Ph.D. in Mathematics	UP Diliman	August 2021 to July 2024	DOST
b. Mayumi B. Morallo	Ph.D. in Applied Linguistics	De La Salle University	August 2021 to July 2024	CHED-SIKAP
c. Michelle E. Yoro	Ph.D. in Applied Linguistics	De La Salle University	August 2021 to July 2024	CHED-SIKAP
d. Kennedy C. Cuya	Doctor in Information Technology	University of Cordilleras	August 2021 to July 2024	CHED-SIKAP
e. Ariel B. Barreda	Ph.D. in Criminal Justice	University of Cordilleras	August 2021 to July 2024	CHED-SIKAP
f. Rowell John B. Artiaga	Doctor in Information Technology	University of Cordilleras	August 2021 to July 2024	CHED-SIKAP
g. Yolda T. Abante	Ph.D. in Development Studies	UP Los Baños	August 2021 to July 2022	Institutional Scholar
h. Marjorie C. Atole	MS in Environmental Engineering	UP Diliman	August 2021 to July 2023	CHED-SIKAP
i. Tomas C. Sales	Doctor of Business Administration	Ateneo de Naga	University Scholarship Dissertation Grant	
j. Joella Mizchelle Dela Vega – Dacillo	Ph.D. in Environmental Economics	Kochi University, Japan	June 2021 to May 2024	Japanese government (Monbukaga kusho)

- VPAA
- VPAF
- HRD
- Deans
- Finance Division
- Scholars
- All concerned

Resolution No. 62, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the authority for the University President to enter into contract with South Scalar Builders Corp. for the repair of various building (COED Bldg./HS Bldg./Roco Bldg.) – Goa Campus amounting to P1,449,391.56 (ABC: P1,672,626.81) from Fund 441, as endorsed by the Bids and Awards Committee (BAC), subject to strict compliance with R.A. 9184, DBM issuances, COA circulars, and other existing laws.	▪ VPAF ▪ BAC ▪ PPF ▪ Finance Division ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 63, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the authority for the University President to enter into contract with Denver's Computer Shoppe, Inc. for the procurement of IT equipment for Finance, Procurement / BAC Offices amounting to P1,136,664.00 (ABC: P1,140,000.00) from Fund 441, as endorsed by the Bids and Awards Committee (BAC), subject to strict compliance with R.A. 9184, DBM issuances, COA circulars, and other existing laws.	▪ VPAF ▪ BAC ▪ Procurement Office ▪ Supply Office ▪ ICTMO ▪ Finance Division ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 64, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the authority for the University President to enter into contract with DGPJR Construction for the repair of Library Building – Goa Campus amounting to P1,703,890.13 (ABC: P2,000,000.00) from Fund 441, as endorsed by the Bids and Awards Committee (BAC), subject to strict compliance with R.A. 9184, DBM issuances, COA circulars, and other existing laws.	▪ VPAF ▪ BAC ▪ PPF ▪ Finance Division ▪ VPAF ▪ University Library ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 65, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the authority for the University President to enter into contract with JVM Ceguera Construction and Supply for the building accessories and improvement of HRM/Tourism Building – San Jose amounting to P885,827.07 (ABC: P1,000,000.00) from Fund 441, as endorsed by the Bids and Awards Committee (BAC), subject to strict compliance with R.A. 9184, DBM issuances, COA circulars, and other existing laws.	▪ VPAF ▪ BAC ▪ PPF ▪ San Jose Campus ▪ Finance Division ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 66, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the authority of the University President to sign Contracts (below 5M) for infrastructure and services using Alternative Mode of Procurement for 3rd Quarter CY 2021, subject to strict compliance with R.A. 9184, DBM issuances, COA circulars, and other existing laws. To wit: a. Capellan Mega Construction Co. for the minor repair of Printing Press, Technology Center and Review Center at PSU Goa Campus amounting to P260,262.14 (ABC: P270,000.00) from Fund 101; b. MCJ Summit Enterprise for the minor repair and maintenance of PSU Gymnasium – Goa amounting to P398,280.75 (ABC: P403,136.84) from Fund 101; c. Capellan Mega Construction Co. for the building accessories and remaining works of Graduate Studies Building at PSU Goa Campus amounting to P386,754.94 (ABC: P400,000.00) from Fund 101; d. Christinajoy Construction for the additional works for the Construction of Marine Food Science Building – Lagonoy	▪ VPAF ▪ Procurement Office ▪ Supply Office ▪ BAC ▪ PPF ▪ Finance Division ▪ Graduate Studies ▪ Lagonoy Campus ▪ OSAS ▪ Caramoan Campus ▪ All concerned

amounting to P1,922,822.23 (ABC: P1,922,822.23) from Fund 101 (negotiated - adjacent or contiguous); e. Capellan Mega Construction Co. for the repair of Student Center at PSU Goa Campus amounting to P199,797.94 (ABC: P207,794.00) from Fund 441; and, f. Lemono Construction & Supply for the water system improvement at PSU Caramoan Campus amounting to P239,622.88 (ABC: P240,000.00) from Fund 441.	
Resolution No. 67, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and between Partido State University and Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR), re: Adopton of 285 hectares portion of the National Greening Program (NGP) Site to serve as field laboratory for BS Forestry program, subject to compliance with pertinent government rules and laws.	▪ VPAA ▪ Dr. Morcilla ▪ Tinambac Campus ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 68, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Understanding by and between Partido State University and University of the Philippines Visayas (UPV), re: Continued collaboration on research, instruction, training and other extension services, subject to compliance with pertinent government rules and laws.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Office ▪ Deans ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 69, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and between Partido State University and Land Bank of the Philippines (LBP), re: Link Biz Portal, subject to compliance with pertinent government rules and laws.	▪ VPAF ▪ Dr. Gumba ▪ Finance Division ▪ Graduate School ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 70, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and between Partido State University and Commission on Higher Education (CHED), re: Agricultural Competitiveness Enhancement Fund – Grants-in-Aid for Higher Education Program (ACEF-GIAHEP), subject to the usual government accounting and auditing procedures.	▪ VPAA ▪ VPAF ▪ Dr. Barcillano ▪ OSAS ▪ Finance Division ▪ Deans ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 71, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and among Partido State University, Bicol University (BU), Central Bicol State University of Agriculture (CBSUA), Local Government Unit (LGU) - Caramoan, and Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources V (BFAR V), re: Enhancing Coral Reef Assessment and Management Capability in Caramoan, Camarines Sur: A Municipal Wide Initiative Towards the National Coral Assessment Program, subject to compliance with pertinent government rules and laws.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Office ▪ Extension Services Office ▪ Mr. Burce ▪ Caramoan Campus ▪ Deans ▪ All concerned

Resolution No. 72, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and among Partido State University, Community Environment and Natural Resources Offices (CENRO) – Goa, and Local Government Unit (LGU) – Tabgon, Caramoan, re: Enhancing Regenerating Capacity of Mangrove Ecosystem through the Establishment of Mangrove Nursery, subject to compliance with pertinent government rules and laws.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Office ▪ Extension Services Office ▪ Mr. Burce ▪ Caramoan Campus ▪ Deans ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 73, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and between Partido State University and Barangay Council of Vinagre, re: 3 in 1 Puto Making Machine, subject to the usual government accounting and auditing procedures.	▪ VPREKM ▪ Extension Services Office ▪ CET ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 74, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and between Partido State University and Home Development Mutual Fund (Pag-IBIG Fund), re: Implementation of the Online STL application through Virtual Pag-IBIG, subject to compliance with pertinent government rules and laws.	▪ VPAF ▪ Finance Division ▪ Faculty ▪ Non-teaching personnel ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 75, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and between Partido State University and Vongchavalitkul University (VU) in Thailand, re: Academic Collaboration, subject to compliance with pertinent Philippine government rules and laws.	▪ VPAA ▪ Dr. Magat ▪ COED ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 76, s. 2021 A resolution confirming the Memorandum of Agreement by and between Partido State University and the University of Kansas Biodiversity Institute in United States of America, re: academic and research cooperation, subject to compliance with pertinent Philippine government rules and laws.	▪ VPREKM ▪ R&D Office ▪ Dr. Clores ▪ Caramoan Campus ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 77, s. 2021 A resolution approving and endorsing to the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) the proposal entitled, "Establishment of Bioassay and Potential Drug Screening Research Laboratory: A research laboratory dedicated for natural products research and potential drug discovery" (Proposed Budget: P4,000,000.00), for possible funding under CHED-IDIG Grant, provided it is compliant with the CHED directives and other applicable government issuances.	▪ VPAA ▪ San Jose Campus ▪ Mr. Gasga ▪ All concerned
Resolution No. 78, s. 2021 A resolution approving and endorsing to the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) the proposal entitled, "Establishment of DOH Accredited Water Testing Laboratory at Partido State University" (Proposed Budget: P2,630,000.00), for possible funding under CHED-IDIG Grant, provided it is compliant with the CHED directives and other applicable government issuances.	▪ VPAA ▪ CET ▪ Engr. Padayao ▪ All concerned

Resolution No. 79, s. 2021 A resolution approving and endorsing to the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) the proposal entitled, "Establishment of Partido State University Reading Center" (Proposed Budget: P2,969,856.40), for possible funding under CHED-IDIG Grant, provided it is compliant with the CHED directives and other applicable government issuances.	▪ VPAA ▪ COED ▪ Dr. Magat ▪ Ms. Amoroso ▪ All concerned

All the proposals that were endorsed by the BOR Academic Committee and BOR Administration, Infrastructure and Finance (AIF) Committee were acted favorably by the Board. There were no deferred items on this meeting.

Meanwhile, everyone is expected to cooperate with the persons or offices concerned for the implementation of the approved resolutions.

For more information regarding the approved resolutions, kindly coordinate with the Board Secretary.

For widest dissemination and strict compliance.

RAUL G. BRADECINA, Ph.D.
SUC President III

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Subject: Establishment of Partido State University Research Ethics Committee (PSUREC)

Rationale: The Board is vested with the authority to enact rules and regulations not contrary to law as may be necessary to carry out the purposes and functions of the university or college. Moreover, part of the Partido State University mandate is to undertake advanced studies, **research**, production and extension services, and shall provide leadership in these areas.

Legal Basis: Paragraph (a), Section 4 of RA 8292; Section 2 of RA 9029 (PSU Charter)

Brief Description of the Proposal:

According to Davies (2020) research ethics committees (REC) review proposed studies with human participants to ensure that they conform to internationally and locally accepted ethical guidelines, monitor studies once they have begun, and take part in follow up action and surveillance after the end of the research. Committees have the authority to approve, reject or stop studies or require modifications to research protocols. The REC is a key element of university administration and has gained increasing importance as a review mechanism for those institutions that wish to conduct responsible research along with safeguarding research ethics standard and scientific merit.

The Partido State University Research Ethics Committee (PSUREC) aims to:

1. Safeguard the dignity, right, well-being and safety of all research participants including those undertaking the research either as investigators or research assistants;
2. Ensure that all research protocols submitted to the PSUREC for implementation meet the ethical standards set forth by international and local guidelines, laws and policies;
3. Undertake a balanced assessment of the risk and benefits involved in any research undertaking; and
4. Promote integrity on research data by making independent decisions regarding a protocol review.

The deliverables of the PSUREC for the next two to three years are the following:

1. Review and approve at least 10 research protocols (internal / external).
2. Submit detailed annual report of the committee to the Philippine Research Ethics Board for renewal of accreditation and possible application for level 2 accreditation.
3. Have systematic filing, have adequate administrative support as shown by the assigned office with standard equipment, a budget that supports honoraria for and training of the REC members, and a functional data base.

The Operational Plan, Committee Members and their Responsibilities, Appointment of Members, Program and Facilities are also included in the proposal.

The total budgetary requirements for the first year of operation is P100,000.00 allocated for the honorarium of external member. The source of fund will be the Research Income 2022.

Endorsement : University Research, Extension & Knowledge Management Council

Draft Resolution:

BOR Resolution No. ____, s. 2021

A resolution approving the Establishment of Partido State University Research Ethics Committee (PSUREC), subject to compliance with pertinent CHED directives and applicable government issuances.

Attachments:

- UREKM Council Certification dated September 30, 2021
- Proposal
- Standard Operating Procedure (Adopted from the Philippine Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedure)

Republic of the Philippines
PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY
Goa, Camarines Sur
Tel. No. (054) 453-0235 · Fax No. (054) 453-1811

UNIVERSITY RESEARCH, EXTENSION & KNOWLEDGE MANAGEMENT COUNCIL

CERTIFICATION

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN:

This is to certify that the University Research, Extension and Knowledge Management Council during its 3rd Quarter Regular UREKM Council Meeting for 2021 held on September 14, 2021 has reviewed and endorsed for approval of the Board of Regents the herein UREKMC Resolution No. 33 s. 2021, the proposed "**Establishment of Partido State University Research Ethics Committee (PSUREC).**

Issued this 30th day of September, 2021 for reference purposes of the Board of Regents.

LUISA M. LANCISO
UREKMC Secretary

ATTESTED:

PATRICIA M. CANDELARIA
Vice President for Research, Extension & Knowledge Management

Republic of the Philippines
PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY
Goa, Camarines Sur

RESEARCH AND EXTENSION DIRECTION AND UTILIZATION Committee

CERTIFICATION

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN:

This is to certify that the proposal entitled "**Proposed Establishment of PSU Research Ethics Committee**" has been reviewed and endorsed by the RDE Direction and Utilization Committee during its committee meeting held last August 27, 2021 for approval of the University Research, Extension and Knowledge Management Council.

Issued this 30th day of September 2021 for reference purposes of the Board of Regents.

PATRICIA M. CANDELARIA
Chair, Committee on Research
and Extension Direction and Utilization

I. Title of Proposal: **ESTABLISHMENT OF PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE (PSUREC)**

II. Proponent: **DIOMERL EDWARD BALDO**
PATRICIA M. CANDELARIA

III. RATIONALE:

Research ethics committees (REC) review proposed studies with human participants to ensure that they conform to internationally and locally accepted ethical guidelines, monitor studies once they have begun, and take part in follow up action and surveillance after the end of the research. Committees have the authority to approve, reject or stop studies or require modifications to research protocols. The REC is a key element of University administration and has gained increasing importance as a review mechanism for those institutions that wish to conduct responsible research along with safeguarding research ethics standard and scientific merit (Davies, 2020).

Research ethics committees have an important role to play in ensuring the ethical standards and scientific merit of research involving human subjects. There are three important obligations placed on the ethics committee. Firstly, and most importantly, the ethics committee must ensure that the rights of research participants are protected. Secondly, the research ethics committee has an obligation to society which provides the resources for research and will ultimately be affected by the results. Thirdly, the research ethics committee has an obligation to the researcher. The research proposal should be treated with respect and consideration.

It is essential to recognize that while the dominant discourse and development of regulatory frameworks may have been driven by health and biomedical disciplines, it is equally important to acknowledge that, although research methodologies and analytical paradigms may differ, all research, including social science research and trans-disciplinary research must be judged against the same ethical principles' (South Africa DOH, 2004).

Ethics review by a research ethics committee is required by international ethical standards governing research involving human participants, as well as by local law in many jurisdictions (WHO, 2019), thus the efforts to comply with the pertinent documents to the Philippine Research Ethics Board (PHREB) for the accreditation of a Level 1 academic institution-based REC (AI-REC) which shall be named Partido State University Research Ethics Committee (PSUREC).

State Universities and Colleges are authorized by law/charter to conduct research and extension services, including projects that will improve and intensify the government's existing COVID-19 responses. The President in his reports had identified the efforts undertaken by CHED such as mobilizing HEIs to assist in the production and distribution of items (such as disinfectants, alcohol, face shields, etc.,) for use by frontline service providers. More is expected to SUCs in these trying times. The efforts to these types of researches can be realized if the protocol has been reviewed by an accredited research ethics committee.

The PSU Ethics Review Committee will form a vital part in the University Research, Extension and Knowledge Management Organizational Structure (Fig.1). It will be an independent body that will conduct pre, during and post ethics review for proposals, on-going and completed researches of student, faculty and external clients.

The attached PSU Research Ethics Committee Standard Operating Procedure (PSU REC-SOP) based from 2020 PHREB SOP shall serve as guideline in the implementation of this committee.

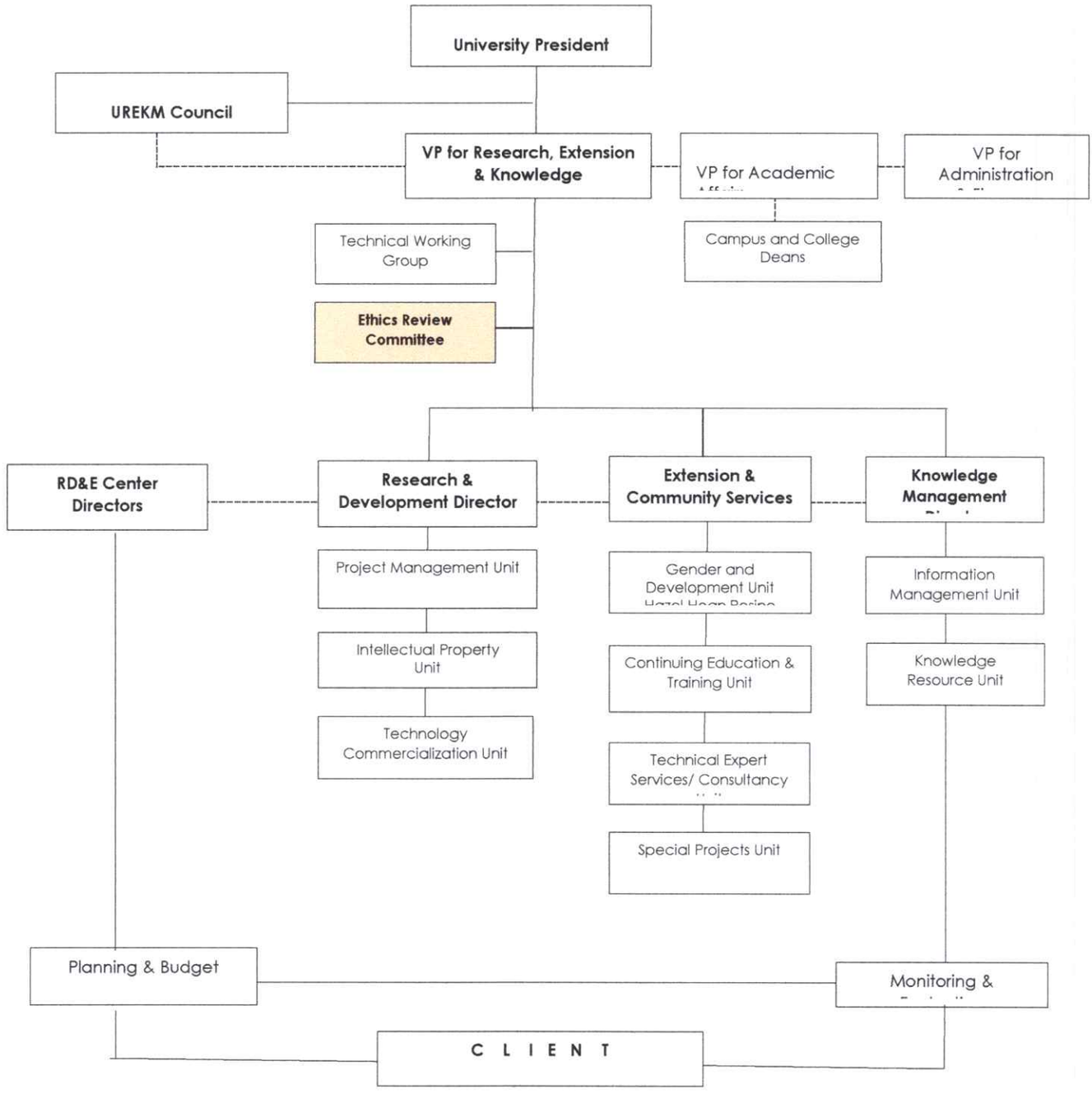


Figure 1. University Research, Extension and Knowledge Management Organizational Structure

IV. OBJECTIVES:

The PSUREC aims to:

1. Safeguard the dignity, right, well-being and safety of all research participants including those undertaking the research either as investigators or research assistants;
2. Ensure that all research protocols submitted to the PSUREC for implementation meet the ethical standards set forth by international and local guidelines, laws and policies;

3. Undertake a balanced assessment of the risk and benefits involved in any research undertaking;
4. Promote integrity of research data by making independent decisions regarding a protocol review,

V. THE PROPOSAL

A. OPERATIONAL PLAN

The first year of the committee's operation will be in accordance with the limitations prescribed as a Level 1 Accredited REC. The committee can receive and evaluate research protocols from student researchers and other external entities The committee shall take responsibility on the following key activities:

1. Posting of PHREB Accreditation Certificate

A REC shall post or display its duly-secured certificate of PHREB accreditation in a conspicuous area within its office.

2. Submission of Annual Report within the first quarter of the following year using the PHREB Form No. 1.2: Annual Report which will reflect the following:

   a. changes in committee chair and membership;
   b. trainings attended by current members;
   c. number and type of protocols reviewed, approved, revised, and disapproved;
   d. summary of recognitions received by the REC or significant events that have affected the performance of its duties; and
   e. Challenges / issues encountered.

3. Reporting of any controversial or important ethical issues in the course of its work

4. Apply for renewal by complying with the requirements/responsibilities of accredited RECs before the expiration of the accreditation.

B. COMMITTEE

The ethics committee as prescribed in the PHREB SOP will compose of REC Chairperson, REC co-chairperson, RE secretary, REC members including external REC member (Fig.2).

1. Chairperson

The chairperson is responsible to chair the meetings and liaise directly with the head of the Institute, report the meeting outcomes to the University President, invite independent consultants to provide special expertise to the PSUREC on proposed research protocol. The Chair shall review and sign along with the member secretary all the minutes, proposals and work towards the smooth function of the committee.

Other specific duties include:

a. Represents the committee on the research organizational structure of PSUREC.
b. Recommends policy amendments and changes.
c. Prepares the budget and proposes membership.

d. Oversees the operations of the PSUREC Members.
e. Acts on suggestions, complaints and queries from stakeholders

2. Co-Chairperson

The co-chairperson is responsible to chair the meetings in the absence of the Chairperson and act as alternate Chair during meetings.

3. Member Secretary

The member secretary is responsible for the administrative aspect of the PSUREC.

4. Secretariat

The Secretariat is composed of the Member Secretary and the administrative supporting staff who has knowledge in basic ethics and act as lower division clerk. It is mandatory that the clerical assistant and peon should be a permanent employee to ensure efficient record keeping and retrieval of documents. The supporting staff are appointed by the University President.

The Secretariat shall have the following functions:

a. Organize PSUREC meetings regularly
b. Preparation and maintenance of meeting agenda and minutes
c. Receive and check for the completeness of the documents for review by the PSUREC
d. Arrange the Committee Members' meeting for finalization of the Participant Information Sheet and Informed Consent Form (*Assent information sheet and assent form wherever applicable*).

5. PSUREC Members

a. The role of the scientific and/or medical member is to focus on the review of the study protocol while the role of the non-scientific or independent lay member is to focus on the review of the informed consent process and form.
b. The roles of the institutional and non-institutional (independent lay) members in terms of the review are similar, however, the non-institutional (independent lay) member is expected to provide an external perspective to ensure the independence of the position of the PSU Research Ethics Committee, even from possible bias posed by its own institution that may the impact rights, safety, and well-being of human subjects in research.
c. Makes a timely and thorough review and decision regarding protocols given to him/her for evaluation.
d. Familiarizes him/herself with the PSUREC Standard Operation Procedure (SOP), his/her terms of reference, and the international and national guidelines on research ethics.
e. Participates actively in the Committee meetings. It is expected that a member will have at least 80% attendance during the period of appointment because attendance is integral to the effectiveness of the committee as a review board.
f. Participates in the review of the progress reports, final reports, and other amendments presented during the ERC meeting.
g. Participates in Site Visits and similar activities as needed.
h. Maintains confidentiality of the documents and deliberations of committee meetings.
i. Declares any conflict of interest in general and for specific protocols for review.

j. Participates in required training with proof of attendance in such training activity submitted to the PSUREC.
k. Submits an updated and signed CV at the start of each calendar year.
l. Refers to the PSUREC Chair any suggestion, complaint, or grievance of research participants, and/or sponsors before acting on them.
m. Performs other PSUREC-related duties that may be requested of him/her by the Chair.

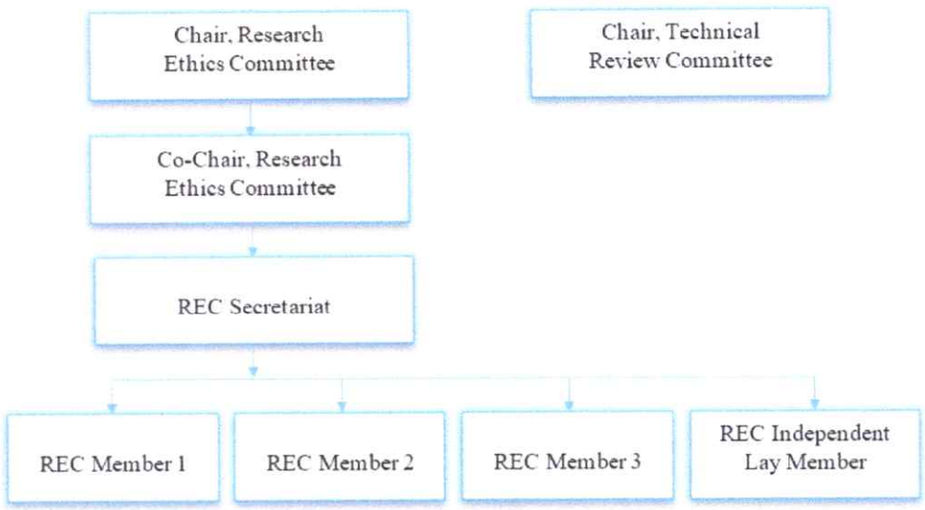


Figure 2. PSU Research Ethics Committee

C. APPOINTMENT OF MEMBERS

Members shall be appointed by the REC Chair for a three-year renewable term. Members shall be appointed based on, but not limited to:

1. Their willingness to commit the time required for their duties on the Committee.
2. Their expert knowledge in medicine, science, or another field as appropriate.
3. Their willingness to acquire knowledge of research ethics through appropriate training and education within two months of beginning service on the Committee.

To ensure the independence of the REC and the ability of its members to exercise their judgement concerning matters coming before the REC, they may be removed from the REC by the Chair for the following grounds:

1. Failure to attend three consecutive meetings for which they had previously committed without informing the Secretariat in advance of the meetings.
2. Failure to attend at least 40% of the REC meetings in any given year.
3. Negligence to perform the functions expected of REC members, including serving as primary reviewer of assigned research proposals.
4. Flagrant departure from REC Standard Operating Procedure.
5. Receipt of any item of value as a means of influencing the decisions of the member regarding a submitted protocol.

In case of vacancy or resignation or termination of any member of the PSUREC:

1.The PSUREC Chair shall recommend to the University President for an advertisement to be placed at the PSU Website for the said vacancy.

2. The PSUREC Chair may admit recommendations from other members of any potential member. The chair will review the curriculum vitae and conduct an interview of the applicant for the position. The Chair will then recommend to the University President all qualified applicants for the position.
3. The University President will appoint the applicant for the position of a member of the PSUREC.

D. DELIVERABLES

For the next two to three years, the Committee shall

1. Review and approve at least 10 research protocols (internal/ external)
2. Submit detailed annual report of the committee to the Philippine Research Ethics Board for renewal of accreditation and possible application for level 2 accreditation.
3. Have systematic filing, have adequate administrative support as shown by an assigned office with standard equipment, a budget that supports honoraria for and training of the REC members, and a functional database.

E. PROGRAMS AND FACILITIES

1. Research Programs

One of the requirements for the appointment of committee chair and members is the attendance and participation to various type of PHRED-SIDTA Research Ethics Training Programs. The committee has allotted budget to the following trainings:

a. Basic Research Ethics Training
   Content:
   i. Definition of Terms
   ii. Scientific Soundness
   iii. Research Ethics Principles (Beneficence, non-maleficence, autonomy, justice)
   iv. Declaration of Helsinki
   v. Research Ethics Review
   vi. Informed Consent
   vii. Authorship
   viii. Review of the Research Proposal
   ix. Ethics Review System
   x. Ethics Review Committees
   xi. Ethical Researcher

b. Good Research Practice
   Content:
   i. Definition of Terms
   ii. Review of different methodologies (eg social research)
   iii. Research Ethics Principles
   iv. Review of the research proposal
   v. Nuremberg code
   vi. National Ethics Guidelines
   vii. ERC-Organization, function, and responsibilities
   viii. Vulnerable population in research
   ix. SOPs

c. Advanced/focused workshop
   Content:
   i. SOPs
   ii. Conflict of Interests (COI)
   iii. Informed Consent
   iv. ERCs
   v. Training of trainers
   vi. Training of evaluators

2.Office Facilities

The committee shall have a dedicated office space, with basic equipment (computer with internet connection and printer, filing cabinets with locks), contents of the active and inactive cabinets or filing system, poster of the general flow chart of REC procedures, and a designated staff secretary.

F. **BUDGETARY REQUIREMENTS** (for the 1st year of operation)

Particulars	**Amount** (PhP)
Honorarium for External Member	100,000.00

Source: Research Income 2022

V. EFFECTIVITY

The Establishment of Partido State University Research Ethics Committee shall take effect immediately upon the confirmation and approval of the Board of Regents.

VI. Proponents:

Prepared by:

DIOMERL EDWARD B. BALDO

PATRICIA M. CANDELARIA

VII. References:

National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Related Research 2017
PHREB Policies and Requirements for Accreditation of Research Ethics Committee
PHREB SOP Workbook 2020

PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY

Research Ethics Committee

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

(Adopted from 2020 PHREB SOP)

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Management of Queries and Complaints
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REC Structure & Composition (Selection and Appointment of Members)

The REC will be multidisciplinary and multi-sectoral in composition. The committee is composed of a minimum of 8, and maximum of 15 members. The members have an equitable representation of all departments in the institution. It includes clinicians and non-clinicians, research methodology expert, economist, biologist, statistician, historian, etc.

The REC will be comprised of a Chair, a Co-Chair, a secretary and 5 active members who represent an appropriate balance of professional, ethical, legal, cultural, educational, spiritual and community interests.

The committee should have adequate representation of age, gender, community, etc to safeguard the interests and welfare of all sections of the community/ society. Members are expected to be aware if local, social, and cultural norms, as this is the most important social control mechanism. The member should have various backgrounds to pro mote complete and adequate review of research activities commonly conducted by that institution.

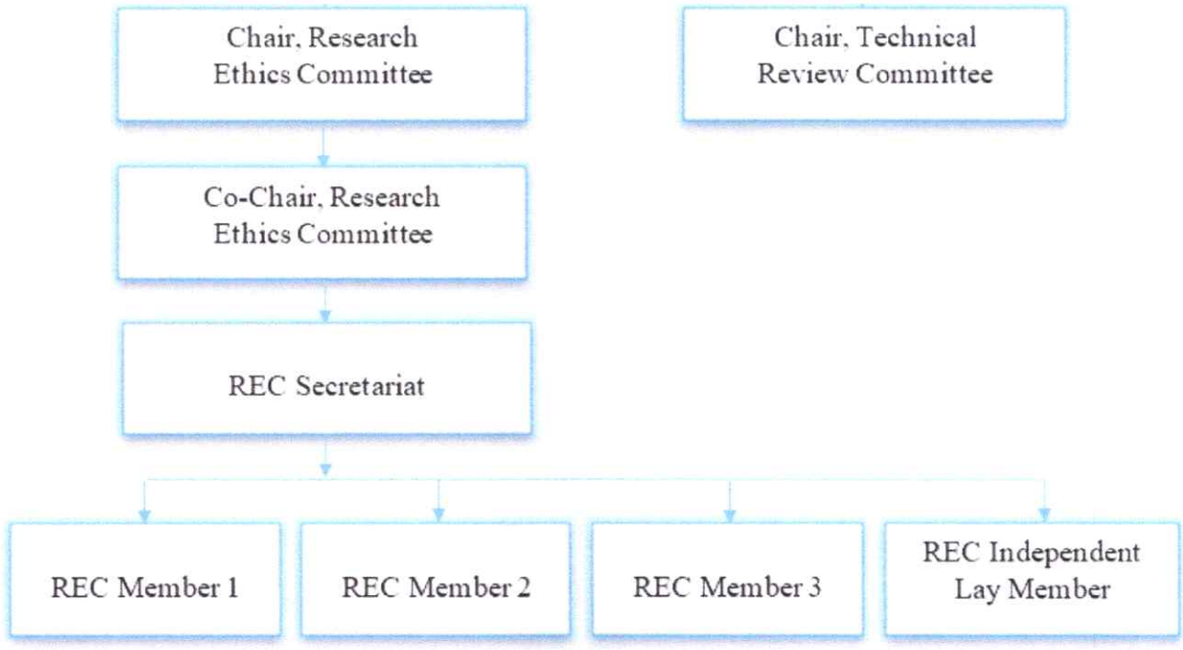


Figure 1: Organizational Structure of the
Partido State University Research Ethics Committee

APPOINTMENT OF MEMBERS

Activity	Responsible
Appoint REC Chair and Co-Chair	University President
⇩	
Appoint REC Secretary, REC Members,	REC Chair
⇩	
Sign conforme	REC Chair, REC Secretary, REC Members
⇩	
File appointment documents	REC Secretary

Members shall be appointed by the REC Chair for a three-year renewable term. Members shall be appointed based on, but not limited to:

1. Their willingness to commit the time required for their duties on the Committee.
2. Their expert knowledge in medicine, science, or another filed as appropriate.
3. Their willingness to acquire knowledge of research ethics through appropriate training and education within two months of beginning service on the Committee.

To ensure the independence of the REC and the ability of its members to exercise their judgement concerning matters coming before the REC, they may be removed from the REC by the Chair for the following grounds:

1. Failure to attend three consecutive meetings for which they had previously committed without informing the Secretariat in advance of the meetings.
2. Failure to attend at least 40% of the REC meetings in any given year.
3. Negligence to perform the functions expected of REC members, including serving as primary reviewer of assigned research proposals.
4. Flagrant departure from REC Standard Operating Procedure.
5. Receipt of any item of value as a means of influencing the decisions of the member regarding a submitted protocol.

In case of vacancy or resignation or termination of any member of the PSUREC:

1. The PSUREC Chair shall recommend to the University President for an advertisement to be placed at the PSU Website for the said vacancy.
2. The PSUREC Chair may admit recommendations from other members of any potential member. The chair will review the curriculum vitae and conduct an interview of the applicant for the position. The Chair will then recommend to the University President all qualified applicants for the position.

3. The University President will appoint the applicant for the position of a member of the PSUREC.

DESIGNATION OF OFFICERS

The following officers through their respective responsibilities contribute to the good functioning of the PSUREC:

Chairperson

He/She is responsible to chair the meetings and liase directly with the head of the Institute, report the meeting outcomes to the University President, invite independent consultants to provide special expertise to the PSUREC on proposed research protocol. He/She should work in close co-ordination with the Member Secretary, review and sign along with the member secretary all the minutes, proposals and work towards the smooth function of the committee. Other specific duties include:

1. Represents the committee on the research organizational structure of PSUREC.
2. Recommends policy amendments and changes.
3. Prepares the budget and proposes membership.
4. Oversees the operations of the PSUREC Members.
5. Acts on suggestions, complaints and queries from stakeholders

Co-Chairperson

He/She is responsible to chair the meetings in the absence of the Chairperson and act as alternate Chair during meetings.

Member Secretary

He/She is responsible for the administrative aspect of the PSUREC.

Secretariat

The Secretariat is composed of the Member Secretary and the administrative supporting staff who has knowledge in basic ethics and act as lower division clerk. It is mandatory that the clerical assistant and peon should be a permanent employee to ensure efficient record keeping and retrieval of documents. The supporting staff are appointed by the University President. The Secretariat shall have the following functions:

1. Organizing PSUREC meetings regularly
2. Preparation and maintenance of meeting agenda and minutes

3. Receive and check for the completeness of the documents for review by the PSUREC
4. Arranging Community Members' meeting after the Board meeting for finalization of the Participant Information Sheet and Informed Consent Form. (Assent information sheet and assent form wherever applicable). This helps in making the documents lucid and in simple language, to make for easier decision making by the Committee and reduces considerable time of the committee.

PSUREC Members

1. The role of the **scientific** and/or **medical** member is to focus on the review of the study protocol while the role of the **non-scientific** or **independent** lay member is to focus on the review of the informed consent process and form.
2. The roles of the institutional and non-institutional (independent lay) members in terms of the review are similar, however, the non-institutional (independent lay) member is expected to provide an external perspective to ensure the independence of the position of the PSU Research Ethics Committee, even from possible bias posed by its own institution that may the impact rights, safety, and well-being of human subjects in research.
3. Makes a timely and thorough review and decision regarding protocols given to him/her for evaluation.
4. Familiarizes him/herself with the PSUREC SOP, his/her terms of reference, and the international and national guidelines on research ethics.
5. Participates actively in the Committee meetings. It is expected that a member will have at least 80% attendance during the period of appointment because attendance is integral to the effectiveness of the committee as a review board.
6. Participates in the review of the progress reports, final reports, and other amendments presented during the ERC meeting.
7. Participates in Site Visits and similar activities as needed.
8. Maintains confidentiality of the documents and deliberations of committee meetings.
9. Declares any conflict of interest in general and for specific protocols for review.
10. Participates in required training with proof of attendance in such training activity submitted to the PSUREC.
11. Submits an updated and signed CV at the start of each calendar year.
12. Refers to the PSUREC Chair any suggestion, complaint, or grievance of research participants, and/or sponsors before acting on them.
13. Performs other PSUREC-related duties that may be requested of him/her by the Chair.

APPOINTMENT OF INDEPENDENT CONSULTANTS

Activity	Responsible
Invite independent consultants to the PSUREC	PSUREC Chair
⇩	
Sign conforme and PSUREC FORM 1(C): CONFIDENTIALITY AGREEMENT AND CONFLICT OF INTEREST DISCLOSURE	Independent Consultant
⇩	
Appoint the roster of Independent Consultants	University President
⇩	
Store roster of Independent Consultants in the Independent Consultants File	Secretariat Staff

Detailed Instructions

Invitation of Independent Consultants

The UPMREB Chair determines the external expertise requirements of the different PSUREC panels based on protocols submitted for review during previous years and the available expertise in the current UPMREB composition.

The PSUREC Chair sends invitations to various professionals with specific scientific expertise to be part of the PSUREC roster of Independent Consultants representing expertise not present in the current panels.

EXPEDITED REVIEW

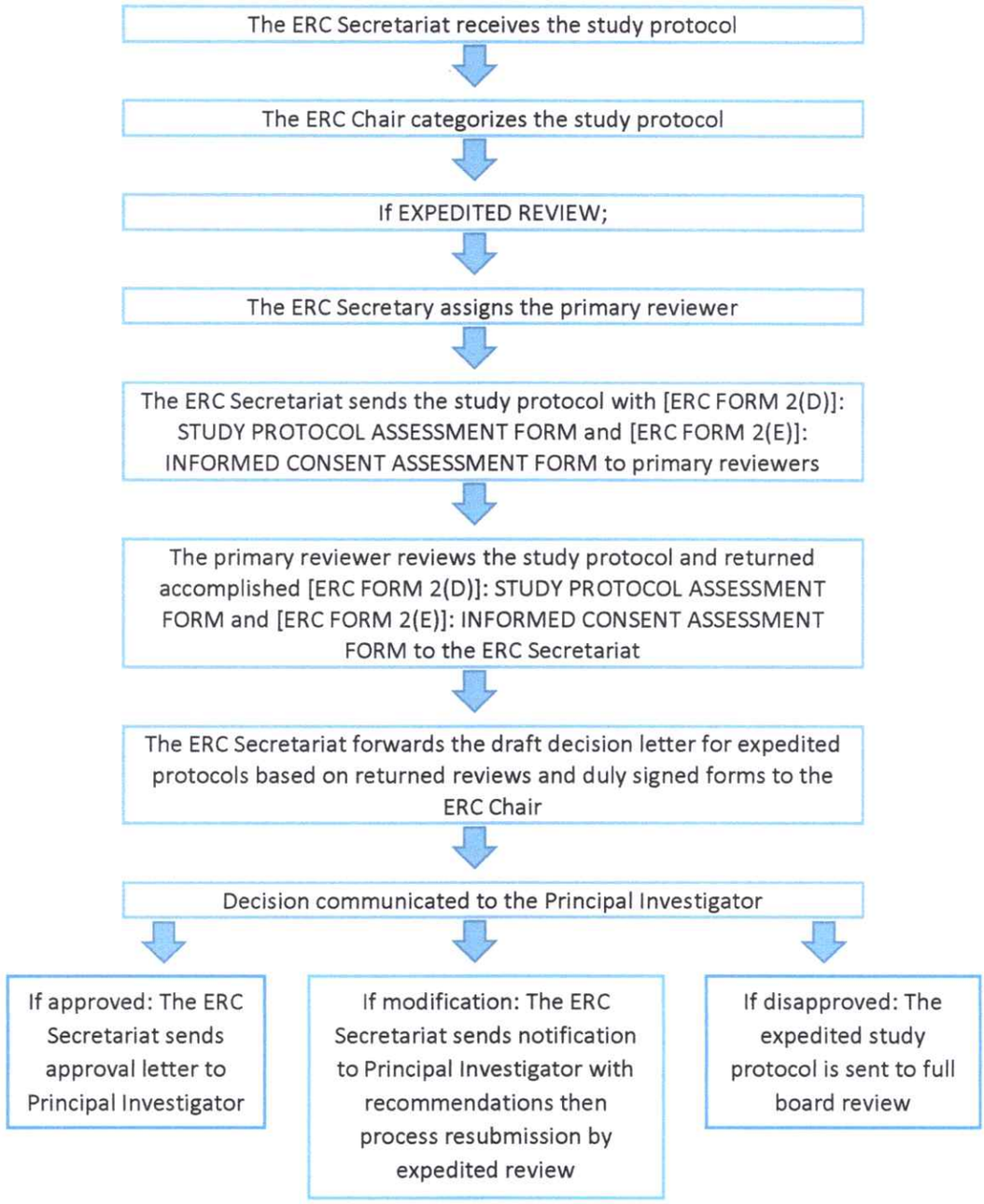
EXPEDITED REVIEW

The protocols involving no more than minimal risk to research participants may be subjected to expedited review. An expedited review may be conducted, only if the protocols involve:

- Revised proposal previously approved through full review by the ERC or continuing review of approved proposals where there is no additional risk or activity is limited to data analysis or health record research
- Anonymous surveys and retrospective chart reviews
- Analysis of discarded pathological specimens / stored paraffin blocks without personal identifiers

- Proposals involving previously banked materials and/or tissues as per policies of respective authorities like – tumour tissue repository, following scientific approval by TRC
- Research activities that involve only procedures listed in one or more of the following categories:
    - Clinical studies of drugs and medical devices only when –
        - Research is on already approved drugs except when,
            - Study of drug interaction
            - Conducting trial on vulnerable population
        - Adverse Event (AE) or unexpected Adverse Drug Reaction (ADR) of minor nature is reported
    - Research involving clinical materials (data, documents, records, or specimens) that have been collected for non-research (clinical) purposes
- Other documents which would be considered for expedited review are as follows but may not restrict to:
    - Minor deviations from originally approved research during the period of approval (usually of one year duration)
    - Change in the name/ address of sponsor
    - Change in contact details of Principal Investigator
    - Change in Principal Investigator or hand over of trials or projects
    - Inclusion or deletion of name/s of Co-Investigator/s
    - Request for change in Principal Investigator , CoInvestigator, change in any member involved in the research
    - Minor amendments in the protocol, CRF
    - Minor corrections in budget
    - Other administrative changes in the IB, ICF, etc.

EXPEDITED REVIEW WORKFLOW



EXPEDITED REVIEW PROCESS

The ERC Secretary assigns the Primary reviewers in a rotating manner from among the members of the ERC. This will consist of one lay member and one scientific member. The Scientific member is responsible for the study protocol assessment form and the lay member is responsible for the informed consent assessment form.

The ERC secretariat forwards the complete research submissions to the primary reviewers.

Primary reviewers review the protocol and return accomplished [ERC FORM 2(D)]: STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM and [ERC FORM 2(E)]: INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM.

The primary reviewers signify their decision by marking the appropriate section of the aforementioned forms and affixing their signature in the space provided. Decision points are: APPROVAL, MODIFICATIONS, DEFERRED and DISAPPROVAL. The decision is submitted to the ERC Sercretariat.

The ERC Secretariat will draft the decision letter for expedited protocols based on the returned review forms and have it approved by the ERC Chair after receiving reviews.

The Principal Investigator will be notified of the decision through an action letter.

Expedited protocols that are for modifications need to submit revised study protocol and resubmission will be processed by expedited review.

Expedited study protocols that are disapproved by primary reviewer are referred for full board review.

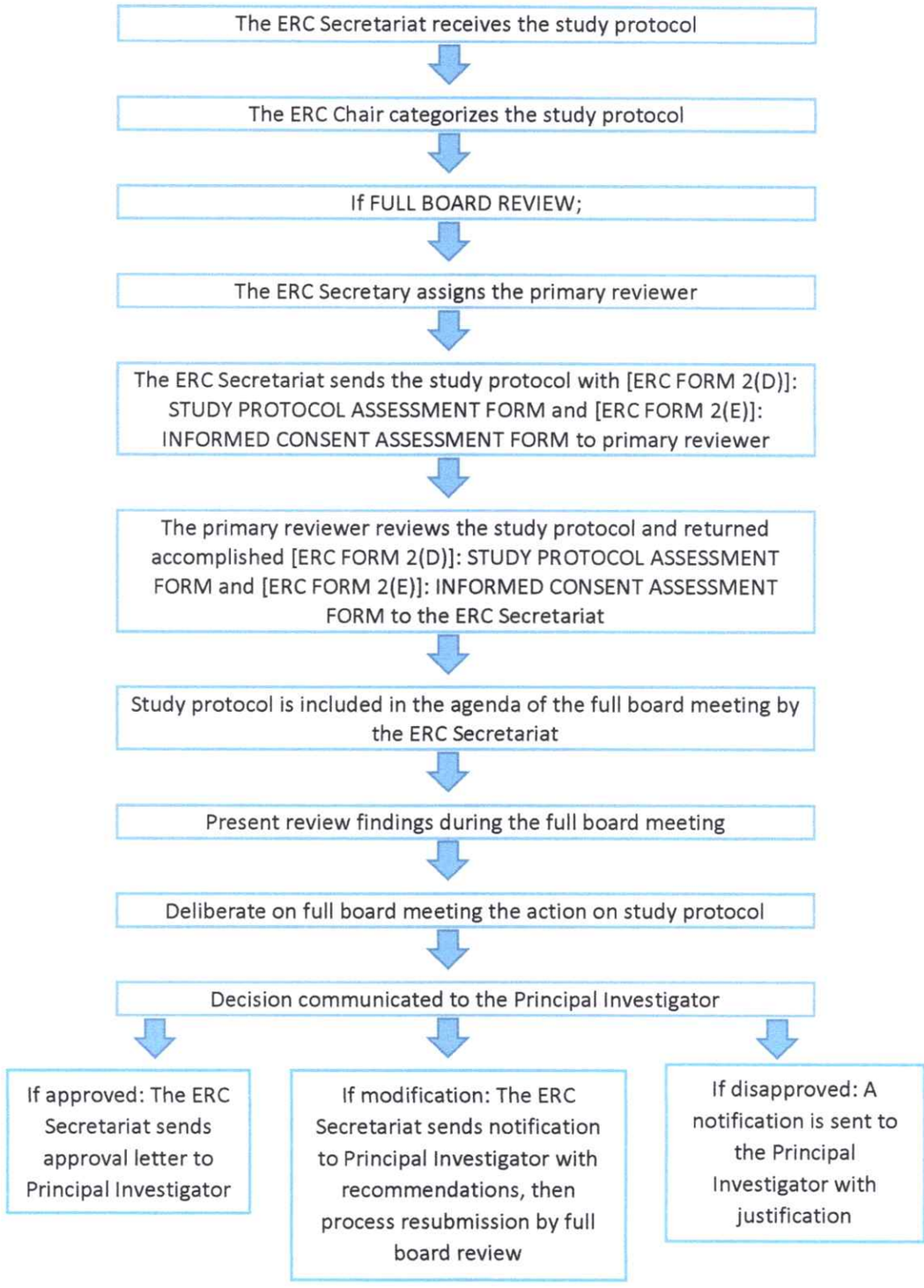
Approved protocols on expedited review will be included on the agenda of the next full board meeting for ratification

FULL BOARD REVIEW

All protocols presenting with more than minimal risk, those which do not qualify for exemption or expedited review and projects that involve vulnerable population and special groups should be subjected to full review by all the members.

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FULL BOARD REVIEW WORKFLOW



FULL REVIEW

Studies that do not qualify for expedited review and received by the PSUREC Secretariat before the full board meeting are included in the agenda.

The PSUREC Secretariat sends study protocols and **[PSUREC FORM 2(D)]: STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM** and **[PSUREC FORM 2(E)]: INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM** to primary reviewers.

Primary reviewers review the study protocol and informed consent documents in accordance with the assessment points and elements detailed in **[PSUREC FORM 2(D)]: STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM** and **[PSUREC FORM 2(E)]: INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM**.

The primary reviewer accomplishes the forms, completely signed and dated and returns them to PSUREC Secretariat prior to committee meeting.

The primary reviewers of full board study protocols present their findings in the PSUREC meeting where action is deliberated.

Study protocols that are for modifications needs to submit revised study protocol

If study protocols are disapproved, a notification is sent to Principal Investigator with justification.

For decisions on resubmissions and post approval submissions, the PSUREC may request information or clarificatory interview from the Principal Investigator as the need arises.

If the Principal Investigator decides not to continue the application for ethics review, the Principal Investigator must write a letter requesting for withdrawal of the study protocol addressed to the committee Chair. All requests for withdrawal will be discussed during full board meetings regardless of initial review classification.

Upon approval of request, study protocol will be archived.

ASSIGNMENT OF PRIMARY REVIEWERS

The PSUREC Secretary assigns one (1) scientific reviewer and one (1) nonscientific or lay member as primary reviewers of the study protocol. Reviewers are selected on the basis of their expertise. The scientific/medical reviewer is tasked to review technical soundness and related ethical issues while the non-scientific reviewer is tasked to review the informed consent process and forms. In the case of clinical trials, a non-scientific reviewer can be represented by a member who is not a medical doctor.

The ERC Secretariat prepares a Primary Reviewer appointment for **[PSUREC FORM 2(I)]: PRIMARY REVIEWER APPOINTMENT** and sends the study protocol package to the assigned primary reviewers.

The ERC Secretariat files the study protocol package in a properly coded study protocol file folder and places it in the Active Study File cabinet.

MANAGEMENT OF INITIAL SUBMISSION AND RESUBMISSION

CONDUCT OF INITIAL REVIEW OR RESUBMISSION

The ERC Chair will ask the primary reviewers to present findings on respective study protocols based on study protocol assessment points specified in RIHS ERC Form 2D: (STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM) for the scientific reviewer and RIHS ERC Form 2E: (INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM) for the lay reviewer.

The scientific primary reviewer is instructed to focus presentation of findings on scientific soundness and its impact on human subject protection, while the lay primary reviewer is instructed to focus presentation of findings on the informed consent process and informed consent form (ICF) and its compliance with the requirements of international and national ethical guidelines, as well as national and institutional policies.

The ERC Members deliberate on the study assessment points and informed consent elements as detailed in the aforementioned forms.

For review of resubmissions, the ERC Chair calls the primary reviewers to present findings on the response of the PI to the previous recommendations of the ERC.

In case of unavailability of the primary reviewers to attend the meeting, said members are required to forward the completed assessment forms to the Secretariat Staff seven (7) days before the meeting. The findings summarized therein will be presented by the ERC Chair or his designee when the study protocol is deliberated on.

For decision on both initial study protocol submission and resubmission, the ERC Chair calls for any of the following actions:

- Approve
- Modification
- Disapprove
- Pending, if major clarifications are required before a decision can be made

Primary Reviewers of study protocols for initial review should be present in the board meeting. In case of unavailability of the primary reviewers to attend the meeting, discussion of the study protocol may still proceed at the discretion of the ERC Chair. Said members are required to forward the completed assessment forms to the Secretariat Staff seven (7) days before the meeting. The findings summarized therein will be presented by the ERC Chair or his designee when the study protocol is deliberated on.

If the primary reviewer feels that there are questions on the protocol that he/she is not qualified to respond to then he/she shall ask the ERC Chair for the presence of an independent Consultant of related specialty to be able to expound or clarify matters regarding the protocol during the meeting at least one week prior to the meeting.

If the ERC Chair likewise feels that the present ERC composition does not have the expertise to proceed with the review, then an appointment will be made for an independent consultant to be present during the discussion of the study protocol.

The RIHS ERC allows investigators and other resource persons (such as an Independent Consultant commissioned by the RIHS ERC or the technical reviewer who endorsed the study protocol) of highly specialized areas to attend the part of the ERC meeting related to specific studies for purposes of clarifying issues related to the study protocol only (and not to present the study protocol to the board).

RECEIPT AND MANAGEMENT OF STUDY PROTOCOL SUBMISSION

Activity	Responsible
Submit to the RIHS ERC Secretariat ERC FORM 2(B): REVIEW CHECKLIST and ERC FORM 2(C): REGISTRATION AND APPLICATION FORM and self-evaluation forms, ERC FORM 2(D): STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM and ERC FORM 2(E): INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM.	Principal Investigator
Secretariat ensures that all required forms and materials are contained within the submitted package and will stamp, sign and date of receipt on the cover letter confirming receipt of the documents. Make a photocopy of the completed document receipt form.	ERC Secretariat
Receive the Original copies of the documents after photocopied by the ERC Secretariat for their records	Principal Investigator
Store all the copies in locked drawers in RIHS ERC office and soft copy of RIHS ERC submission forms /study protocol accepted by email will be saved in RIHS ERC computer and logs the date of submission, name of the receiver and contents of the package on the [ERC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG.	ERC Secretariat

All research proposals must be submitted to the RIHS ERC Secretariat together with the corresponding [ERC FORM 2(B)]: REVIEW CHECKLIST and [ERC FORM 2(C)]: REGISTRATION AND APPLICATION FORM and self-evaluation forms, [ERC FORM 2(D)]: STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM and [ERC FORM 2(E)]: INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM.

The ERC Secretariat ensures that all required forms and materials are contained within the submitted package. Checking is done as per checklist for submissions for initial review.

The ERC Secretariat verify contents of the submitted package, which should include

- Original Application Form for Initial Review or Project submission Form: [ERC FORM 2(B)]: REVIEW CHECKLIST and [ERC FORM 2(C)]: REGISTRATION AND APPLICATION FORM
- Self Evaluation Form: [ERC FORM 2(D)]: STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM and [ERC FORM 2(E)]: INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM
- Study protocol
- Data collection forms (including Case Report Forms)
- CV of PI and study team members
- Electronic copy of study protocol,
- Other related documents necessary for initial review
- A certification that all required documentation is attached which may take the form of items checked off on a cover sheet provided by the [ERC FORM 2(B)]: REVIEW CHECKLIST, and if not, an explanation for any missing documentation and when such documentation will be made available to the Committee.

The ERC Secretariat check completeness of necessary information dates and signature at all appropriate places in the application form submitted for initial review.

The ERC Secretariat state clearly the items missing in the package on the Protocol submission / document receipt form.

The ERC Secretariat will inform the Principal Investigator whether the documentation is complete or incomplete within two working days of submission of the proposal.

Incomplete or incorrect submissions will not be accepted and will be returned.

The ERC Secretariat will stamp, sign and date of receipt on the cover letter confirming receipt of the documents. Make a photocopy of the completed document receipt form and return the original copy to the applicants for their records.

The ERC Secretariat count for correct numbers of hard copies (Initially 15 copies for investigator-initiated studies and 15 copies for pharmaceutical-sponsored studies)

The ERC Secretariat stores the hard copies and soft copy of the research project. The hard copies will be stored in locked drawers in ERC office and soft copy of ERC submission forms /study protocol accepted by email will be saved in ERC computer.

All correspondence for the projects, should quote "RIHS ERC Code"

The project file is coded as "serial number / type of funding / unit or department / year / number" e.g. 0093 / E / H / 13 / 46 will indicate – 0093 as serial number of project, E – extramural, H – Hospital, 13 – year, 46 number of protocols reviewed for the year 2013. (Where P = Pharmaceutical sponsored trials, E = Extramural funding, I = Intramural funding). This coding system will be maintained on the excel sheet (inventory of projects) and also labeled on each project file.

The ERC Secretariat logs the date of submission, name of the receiver and contents of the package on the [ERC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG.

DOCUMENT REQUIREMENTS

The study protocol should be accompanied with the following relevant supporting documents for scientific and ethical review:

Application Forms - [ERC FORM 2(B)]: REVIEW CHECKLIST and [ERC FORM 2(C)]: REGISTRATION AND APPLICATION FORM

Self-Evaluation Forms - [ERC FORM 2(D)]: STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM and [ERC FORM 2(E)]: INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM.

A structured abstract (less than 300 words) should provide a succinct summary of the research question, the population and interventions involved, main outcomes, methods, potential risks for subjects and names of participating institutions and countries. The abstract briefly should mention the potential value of this research for public health.

Disclosure by researchers of their funding sources, sponsors, institutional affiliations and other possible sources of conflicts of interest: real, apparent or perceived or incentives for people participating in the study. The Principal Investigator and co-investigators also shall submit a written declaration disclosing any conflicts of interest affecting the research and/or the research team or about the emergence of material conflicts of interest that may arise during the course of the project.

A complete research proposal that includes

A brief background and justification

Objective/purpose of study and a brief statement as to why the research question(s) is relevant

A schematic diagram of the study

Methodology (including sampling methodology and sample size), procedures and analysis plan

Ethical Considerations of the study which shall include, but not limited to, the possible risk and benefit to the participants; compensation if any for the participants; a description of the arrangements for indemnity.

Limitations, if any

Significance of study with a careful assessment of predictable risks and burdens to the individuals and communities involved in the research in comparison with foreseeable benefits to them and to other individuals or communities affected by the condition under investigation

Plans for dissemination of research results to the relevant stakeholders

Budget and timelines

References

Recent Curriculum vitae (abbreviated, two pages) of the Principal Investigator and any co-investigators signed and dated

Disclosure of previous reviews by other ethical or scientific boards or committees or independent peer reviewers and a copy of the conclusions, recommendations and changes that were incorporated

Agreement to comply with national and international GCP protocols for clinical trials

When the research involves a study product (such as a pharmaceutical or device under investigation), an adequate summary of all safety, pharmacological, pharmaceutical, and toxicological data available on the study product, together with a summary of clinical experience with the study product to date (e.g., recent investigator's brochure, published data, a summary of the product's characteristics)

Informed consent documentation forms that will be used in the study and a description of how the subjects will be protected, including how data safety and monitoring will work and how deaths and unexpected events will be prevented or analyzed and dealt with. The process of informed consent is one of the most important parts of planning a research study. It is important that human participants exercise their right of free will when deciding to participate. It is equally important that participants be given the correct information, comprehend what is being said and read to them and be given time to make their own decision about participation. The language of the informed consent must be comprehensible to the research participants or their guardians. In most cases, this may include a document written in a language that the participant can understand at a fifth-grade reading level. The following should take place during the consent process:

Review of recruitment materials

Verbal instructions

Written material (when appropriate)

Questions and answer sessions

Agreement by documented signature when appropriate (most situations)

Participants must be informed that it is their right to withdraw from a study at any time. The consent form must be communicated in suitable and effective ways to any participant including those with disabilities. Children and other vulnerable subjects may need information presented as simply and straightforwardly as possible. Assent is obtained for children 7 years of age and above.

In cases in which the potential participants cannot read the consent form, it must be read to the individual and a witness' signature is required on the form, indicating that he or she was present during the reading and interpreting of the consent form and that it was presented in a manner that was comprehensible to the subject. If for any reason the informed consent process is waived (e.g. studies in some vulnerable populations), a clear justification has to be provided as well as any alternative arrangement.

The following should be included when appropriate:

Participant Information Sheet

Informed Consent Forms

Assent Forms and Parent Consent Forms (if children / adolescents between 7 – 18 years of age are participants in the trial)

Case report forms, diary cards, and other questionnaires intended for research participants;

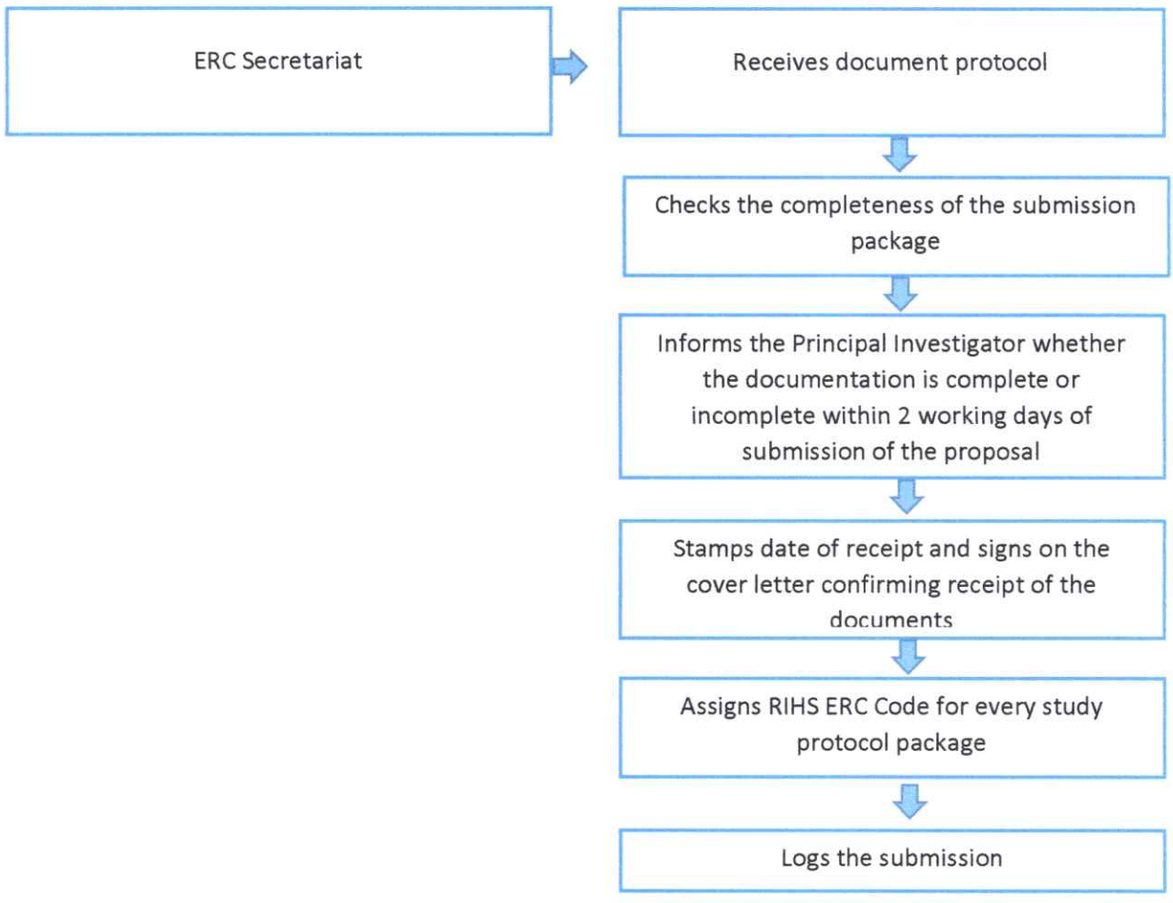
Regulatory clearance for all types of studies from appropriate regulatory authorities, if necessary

Insurance/Indemnity policies, indicating who are covered

A certification that all required documentation is attached which may take the form of items checked off on a cover sheet provided by the RIHS ERC Secretariat(Annex 1), and if not, an explanation for any missing documentation and when such documentation will be made available to the Committee

Other documentation relevant to a research proposal in specific situations

SUBMISSION OF RESEARCH PROTOCOL WORKFLOW



REVIEW OF PROGRESS REPORTS

The Coordinating Project Investigator submits to PSUREC the latest versions of the protocol, informed consent forms (ICF) and summarizes in the progress report form all protocol amendments and protocol deviations/ violations, as well as participant recruitment since the last committee approval.

The PSUREC Secretariat Staff sends the progress report package to the primary reviewers at least 7 days before full-board meeting.

Primary reviewers refer to the progress report document to check if the protocol and the ICF contain updated information related to patient safety. Review comments should consider the following:

1. Risk Assessment: the risks to the subjects are minimized; the risks to the subjects are reasonable in relation to anticipated benefits, if any, and the importance of the knowledge that may be expected to be gained from the study.
2. Adequacy of Informed Consent: Informed consent/Assent forms current (most recent); appropriate, new significant findings since the last continuing review that may be related to the subjects' willingness to continue participation provided to enrolled subjects (e.g., important toxicity or adverse event information)
3. Local Issues: Changes in the investigator's situation or qualifications (e.g., suspension of hospital privileges, medical license; involvement in numerous clinical trials); Evaluation, investigation and resolution of complaints related to the research, if any; Changes in the acceptability of the proposed research in terms of institutional commitments (e.g., personnel and financial resources, adequacy of facilities) and regulations, applicable national law, or standards of professional conduct of practice.); Report from third party observation of the research (including the informed consent process) carried out; Investigator concerns about trial conduct at the local site (e.g., study coordinator ineffectiveness, inability of subjects to understand sections of the informed consent document required by institutional policies), if any.
4. Trial Progress: Start date of the study and expected duration; Total subject enrollment (expected enrollment, actual enrollment, enrollment issues), subject withdrawal (number of subjects who withdrew, lost to follow-up, summary of reasons for withdrawal at local site)

The PSUREC staff includes all progress report submissions in the agenda of the full board meeting for discussion of participating representatives from site RECs.

Approval of progress report reviewed by the Primary Reviewers by expedited procedure is reported to the board meeting by the Chair/Head of SJREB Secretariat.

REVIEW OF PROTOCOL DEVIATION AND VIOLATION

Reporting of Protocol Deviation/Non-Compliance/Violation/Waiver

PSUREC Secretariat is responsible for receiving deviations /violations/waiver reports submitted by the PI and placing it on agenda of the meeting. ERC members should review and take action on such reports.

If the protocol deviation / non-compliance / violation is detected by committee member during monitoring visit he/she will present, the protocol deviation / noncompliance / violation information.

If detected by PSUREC Secretariat / forwarded by Principal Investigator, the Secretary will present the protocol deviation / non-compliance / violation / waiver information.

Receipt and Management of the study protocol noncompliance reports upon submission

The investigator should document, explain, and report to the PSUREC any noncompliance from the approved protocol, whether minor or major, at the soonest possible time.

The investigator may implement a deviation from the protocol to eliminate an immediate hazard(s) to study subjects without prior ERC approval, but must submit as soon as possible, a report of deviation or change, the reasons for it, and, if appropriate, an appropriate study protocol amendment(s).

Reporting of study protocol noncompliance is facilitated through the submission of **[PSUREC FORM 4(D)]: PROTOCOL DEVIATION FORM**, together with documents deemed relevant by the investigator to clarify information indicated in the report. This comprises the study protocol noncompliance report package.

The PSUREC Secretariat checks the submission for completeness and gives a receiving copy of **[PSUREC FORM 4(D)]: PROTOCOL DEVIATION FORM** to the Principal Investigator or his/her representative.

The PSUREC Secretariat logs the date of submission on the **[PSUREC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG**.

Classification of Review by the ERC Chair

The ERC Chair classifies the submission as either full board or expedited review

MINOR PROTOCOL DEVIATION- (non-systematic protocol noncompliance with minor consequences, in terms of its effect on the participant's/subject's rights, safety or welfare, or the integrity of study data; includes deviations that are administrative in nature)

MAJOR PROTOCOL DEVIATION OR PROTOCOL VIOLATION - (persistent protocol noncompliance with potentially serious consequences that could critically affect data analysis or put patients' safety at risk)

Review of Study Protocol Noncompliance Report

The PSUREC Secretariat distributes the study protocol noncompliance report package to ERC Members along with the meeting agenda

The PSUREC Chair / members will review the information available and take a decision depending on the seriousness of the violation.

The decision will be taken to ensure that the safety and rights of the research participants are safeguarded. The decision will be taken by consensus and if no consensus is arrived at, voting will be conducted.

The actions taken by ERC could include one or more of the following:

1. Uphold Original Approval
2. Request Further Information
3. Suspension of Ethical Clearance
4. Cancellation of Ethical Clearance
5. Deferred Action pending major clarification

REVIEW OF SAFETY REPORTS (SAES, SUSARS, RNES)

MANAGEMENT OF AN APPLICATION FOR CONTINUING REVIEW

Continuing review of approved Study Protocol

The purpose of continuing review is to monitor the progress of the entire study which was previously approved; not just the changes in it but to ensure continued protection of the rights

and welfare of research subjects. Continuing review of the study may not be conducted through an expedited review procedure, unless:

1. the study was eligible for, and initially reviewed by, an expedited review procedure; or
2. the study has changed such that the activities remaining are eligible for expedited review

When an approved research proposal is planned to extend for more than one year, the research project shall be reviewed by the PSUREC 12 months after the date of the initial approval, unless the PSUREC determines that a more frequent review is needed. This review shall occur even if, for administrative or other reasons, work on the project has been delayed or no participant has been recruited. When the PSUREC determines that continuing review of an approved project should occur more frequently than once every 12 months or should occur after the accrual of a specified number of participants, the timing of the continuing review shall be set accordingly.

Assuming that no substantive changes have been made in the proposal or consent documents, a continuing review may be conducted as an expedited review. Such an expedited review may be carried out by the Secretariat, on behalf of the PSUREC and will be reported for information at the next PSUREC meeting.

If any substantive changes have been made in the protocol or consent documents, the continuing review shall be conducted as a Full Review.

Should the process of review lead to a disapproval of the continuation of a previously approved study, this determination shall be communicated immediately to the Principal Investigator and to any other people, funding agencies or other bodies with whom such reports must be filed. Principal Investigator promptly shall report back to the PSUREC concerning the date the enrolment of new participants was halted and the manner in which the research project is dealing with the previously enrolled participants.

Receipt and Management of the Continuing Review Application

Ethical clearance or approval is typically granted for a period of one year. After approval, continuing review is required to be done at least once a year, depending on the risk assessment of the study protocol. This is facilitated through the submission of [PSUREC FORM 4(B)]: CONTINUING REVIEW APPLICATION FORM.

The frequency of continuing review is indicated in the [PSUREC FORM 6(B)]: PROTOCOL APPROVAL LETTER, which is provided to the Principal Investigator upon approval of the study.

For ethical clearance or approval approaching the one-year expiry date and requiring a renewal or extension, it is advisable to submit [PSUREC FORM 4(B)]: CONTINUING REVIEW APPLICATION FORM 60 days prior to expiry date.

The PSUREC Secretariat looks through the Study Protocol Database for the titles of study protocols that are due for continuing review at the end of the month.

The continuing review application is facilitated through the submission of [PSUREC FORM 4(B)]: CONTINUING REVIEW APPLICATION FORM, together with the synopsis of the study protocol and current informed consent documents. This comprises the continuing review application package.

The PSUREC Secretariat checks the submission for completeness and gives a receiving copy of [PSUREC FORM 4(B)]: CONTINUING REVIEW APPLICATION FORM to the Principal Investigator or his/her representative.

The PSUREC Secretariat logs the date of submission on the [PSUREC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG.

The PSUREC Secretariat ensures that sufficient copies for the PSUREC Members have been submitted by the Principal Investigator for full board submissions.

REVIEW OF THE FINAL REPORT

Receipt and Management of the final report package upon submission

Upon completion of the study, the investigator should provide the PSUREC with a summary of the outcome of the study, especially of the human participants who were involved, in a form of an end of study report.

The PSUREC Secretariat looks through the Study Protocol Database for the titles of study protocols that are due for final report at the end of the month.

The PSUREC Secretariat informs the respective Principal Investigators of study protocols whose ethical clearances have expired to submit a Final Report at least one month in advance of the due date of review by fax, email, or post using [PSUREC FORM 6(J)]: REMINDER LETTER FOR CONTINUING REPORT FORM and keeps a receiving copy of the communication.

The end of study reporting is facilitated through the submission of [PSUREC FORM 4(C)]: FINAL REPORT FORM, together with documents deemed relevant by the investigator to clarify information indicated in the final report. This comprises the final report package.

The PSUREC Secretariat checks the submission for completeness and gives a receiving copy of [PSUREC FORM 4(C)]: FINAL REPORT FORM to the Principal Investigator or his/her representative.

The PSUREC Secretariat logs the date of submission on the [PSUREC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG.

Review of Final Report

The ERC Secretariat distributes the final report package to ERC Members along with the meeting agenda

The documents are presented to ERC Members when final report is deliberated on.

Communication of the Decision

The Principal Investigator is notified of the ERC decision on the final report through action letter

If the final report is approved, the Principal Investigator is informed of the following:

1. The study protocol is reclassified as INACTIVE.
2. Ethical clearance automatically expired effective on the date of the ERC meeting.
3. The protocol records will be made available for three (3) years after the expiration date.

REVIEW OF AN EARLY TERMINATION REPORT

EARLY STUDY TERMINATION APPLICATION

Receipt and Management of the Early Study Termination Application

An application for early study termination is submitted when a study approved by the PSUREC is being recommended for termination before its scheduled completion. This is done when the safety of the study participant is doubtful or at risk and also upon the request of the PI or the sponsor owing to the existence of unresolvable valid complaints.

Early study termination is facilitated through the submission of [PSUREC FORM 4(E)]: EARLY TERMINATION FORM, together with documents deemed relevant by the investigator to support or clarify information indicated in the application. This comprises the early study termination application package.

The PSUREC Secretariat checks the submission for completeness and gives a receiving copy of [PSUREC FORM 4(E)]: EARLY TERMINATION FORM to the Principal Investigator or his/her representative.

The PSUREC Secretariat logs the date of submission on the [PSUREC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG.

Review of Early Study Termination Application

The PSUREC Secretariat distributes the early study application package to PSUREC Members along with the meeting agenda.

The ERC deliberates on the implications of the application on the rights, safety and welfare of the study participants including adapting specific provisions for continued protection and dissemination of specific information to the study participants.

The PSUREC may request the information from the Principal Investigator or invite the Principal Investigator for clarificatory interview.

Approval of this application would require further completion of [PSUREC FORM 4(C)]: FINAL REPORT FORM.

MANAGEMENT OF APPEALS

CONDUCT OF SITE VISITS

PREPARING FOR A MEETING

Preparation of Meeting/Distribution of Agenda

The PSUREC Secretariat distributes the [PSUREC FORM 2(A)]: NOTICE OF MEETING together with the minutes of the previous meeting and study protocols or study protocol synopses to ERC Members, Independent Consultants and other attendees.

> The protocols received by the PSUREC Secretariat shall be scheduled on the agenda on a first-come first-serve basis.

The PSUREC Members should confirm their attendance within three (3) days before the meeting.

The PSUREC Secretariat sends meeting reminders to all attendees through mobile phone, email or regular telephone the day before the meeting.

The PSUREC Secretariat shall reserve the PSU boardroom on the scheduled meeting date and time. The meeting will be held in the PSU Boardroom, unless otherwise specified. They shall ensure that the room, equipment (projectors, recorder, etc.) and facilities are available in good working condition on the day of the meeting.

Distribution of Protocol

The PSUREC Secretariat shall distribute copies of the protocols to the members either by electronic mail (in case of electronic submission of protocols) or personally within one week of the receipt of the research protocol or at least ten days in advance of the scheduled meeting.

The PSUREC Secretariat shall verify (verbally or by e-mail) with the members whether the protocol packages are received.

It is the responsibility of the member to verify items of the parcel on receipt and in the event of any missing items, report to the PSUREC Secretariat immediately so that the relevant documents could be made available to the members before the meeting.

The PSUREC member shall review the protocol and write his/her comments on the protocol and informed consent assessment forms. The members shall decide on the action needed for the protocol and subsequently sign the Forms prior to the meeting of the PSUREC.

Attendance and Determination of Quorum

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Sign the Attendance sheet prepared by the Secretariat	ERC Chair ○ERC Secretary ○ERC Members
Take record of the attendance of the members in each meeting.	ERC Secretariat
Will preside the meeting as Acting Chairperson if the Chairperson and the Secretary are absent	ERC Independent Lay member
Assure to respect such confidentiality	ERC Chair ○ERC Secretary ○ERC Members ○ERC Secretariat and or Independent Consultant and the invited
Copy of the minutes of the meeting will be filed in the specified folder of each member of the ERC and the corresponding research protocol file	ERC Secretariat

Only the members of the PSUREC and the Secretariat are allowed to attend the meetings unless otherwise specified (Independent Consultants) as permitted under these rules to be present for a particular meeting or a portion thereof.

It is the responsibility of the members to notify the PSUREC Secretariat of their availability to attend the meeting and to give an alternate date in case the quorum requirement is not met.

It is the responsibility of the member to attend each meeting and the PSUREC Secretariat shall take record of the attendance of the members in each meeting.

At the invitation of the PSUREC Chair, the proponent or authorized representative may attend the meeting to give clarifications on the protocol.

At least five members, including the PSUREC Chair, must be present to constitute a quorum. A meeting can only commence once a quorum is obtained. If at any time during the meeting the quorum is lost, the meeting must be concluded. Members of the PSUREC Secretariat and other experts or observers do not count towards the quorum. No quorum should consist entirely of members of one sector or one gender. At all times, the meeting must include at least one member whose primary area of interest/ specialization is nonscientific (lay person) and at least one member who is independent of the institution.

In absence of the PSUREC Chair, the PSUREC Co-chair will preside over the meeting. In absence of both, a member who is independent of the institution will preside the meeting as Acting Chairperson.

PREPARING THE MEETING AGENDA

CONDUCT OF MEETING

The PSUREC Chair, or the Co-chair in the absence of the Chair, shall preside over the meeting and call the meeting to order.

The PSUREC shall follow the Robert's Rules of Order – Parliamentary Rule in the conduct of the meeting.

The PSUREC Secretary shall determine if Quorum is present and if there a noninstitutional member present. Only upon the declaration of both shall the meeting be officially declared open.

The PSUREC Chair calls for declaration of Conflict of Interest (COI) in respect of any study protocol or submission scheduled for review. Members declaring COI are documented by the Secretary. The PSUREC Chair instructs the members who declared COI to recuse themselves from the deliberation of the respective study protocol for which the COI declaration was made.

The PSUREC Secretary presides over the review of the Minutes of the previous meeting. Any corrections to the minutes of the previous meeting shall be noted by the Secretary and incorporated as corrections of the minutes. Any member can declare a motion for approval, which any member can second. The PSUREC Chair then declares approval of the Minutes of the previous meeting.

The PSUREC Chair proceeds to facilitate discussion of matters arising from the minutes, the results of which are noted by the Secretariat Staff for inclusion in the Minutes of the current meeting.

The PSUREC chair proceeds with the discussion of protocols submitted for full board review (See conduct of meeting for full board review).

After all the protocols for full board review have been tackled and decided upon, the PSUREC Chair will proceed to report on protocols submissions for expedited review and full board protocols with modification expedited at the level of the chair which consist of the following:

1. Approved Protocols
2. Study Protocols for Initial Review
3. Resubmissions (study protocols for modification)
4. Study Protocol Amendments
5. Continuing Review Applications
6. Final Reports:
7. Study Protocol Non-Compliance (Deviation or Violation) Reports
8. Early Study Termination Applications
9. Queries or Complaints

When all the protocols have been deliberated upon and decision made, the PSUREC chair proceeds to discuss other matters that the PSUREC needs to decide upon.

If there are no matters left to discuss then the PSUREC Chair will adjourn the meeting.

PREPARING THE MINUTES OF MEETING

The PSUREC Secretary will compile the proceedings of ERC meeting in a concise and easy-to-read style and will check spelling, grammar and context of the written minutes. It should be sent to the committee Chair within a week.

The minutes of the meeting shall include the names and designation of the members who attended to ensure diversity of the membership, the names and designation of those who are absent, the date of the meeting, the title of the protocols reviewed, the agenda of the meeting, the subsequent discussion under each research protocol and the resulting decision of the board for each protocol submitted for deliberation.

The minutes of the committee meeting will be signed by the PSUREC Secretary, as the one who prepared the minutes, and will be approved during the subsequent meeting.

A copy of the minutes of the meeting will be filed in the specified folder of each member and the corresponding research protocol file. The original copy will also be kept by the Secretary in a separate file for future reference.

COMMUNICATING PSUREC DECISIONS

The outcome of a review shall be communicated by the PSUREC Secretariat to the Principal Investigator preferably within one week after the PSUREC meeting when the decision was made.

The communication of the decision shall include, but is not limited, to the following:

3.11.1. The Exact title of the research proposal reviewed

3.11.2. The clear identification of the protocol of the proposed research or amendment, date and version number (if applicable). The names and specific identification number version numbers/dates of the documents reviewed, including the potential research participant information sheet/material and informed consent form

3.11.3. The name and title of the Principal Investigator

3.11.4. The date and place of the decision

3.11.5. The names of the PSUREC members who participated in the deliberation

3.11.6. A clear statement of the decision reached

3.11.7. Any suggestions of the PSUREC

3.11.8. Validity of approval usually will be yearly for multiyear projects, however, may change on case-to-case basis.

3.11.9. A conditional decision (i.e. approval with recommendations or modifications, suggestions for revision and the procedure, any other requirements by the PSUREC), will be valid only for six months from the date of issue of letter. If the Principal Investigator does not comply with the suggestions during these three months, a reminder will be issued. The modifications will be re-reviewed by PSUREC Secretary, PSUREC Members or primary reviewer/s and /or may be referred for full board review.

3.11.10. In the case of a positive decision, the Principal Investigator is notified through an approval letter of the following requirements:

3.11.10.1. A statement of the responsibilities of the Principal Investigator; for example, confirmation of the acceptance of any requirements recommended by the PSUREC

3.11.10.2. Submission of progress report(s) decided on case to case basis, usually yearly

3.11.10.3. The need to notify the PSUREC in cases of protocol amendments (other than amendments involving only logistical or administrative aspects of the study)

3.11.10.4. The need to notify the PSUREC in the case of amendments to the recruitment material like the potential research participant information, or the informed consent form or the need to report serious and unexpected adverse events related to the conduct of the study

3.11.10.5. The need to report unforeseen circumstances, the termination of the study, or significant decisions by other PSUREC

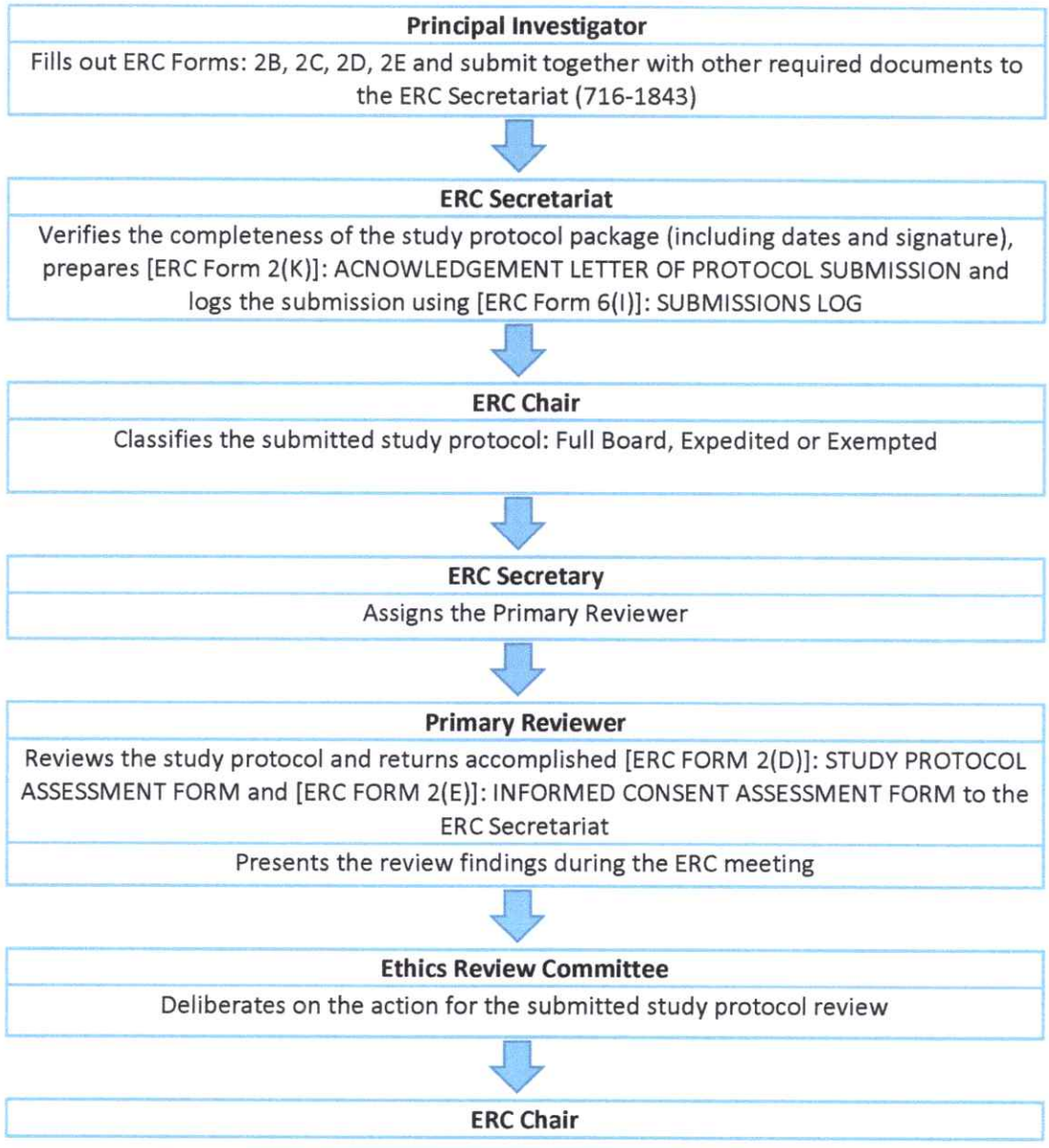
3.11.10.6. The information the PSUREC expects to receive in order to perform ongoing review

3.11.10.7. The final summary or final report

3.11.10.8. The schedule/plan of ongoing review of sponsored trials

3.11.11. In the case of a negative decision, the reasons should be clearly stated in the communication to the Principal Investigator

Please insert here flowchart for ethics review (p33)



Reviews and communicates the decision of the ERC to the Principal Investigator using [ERC FORM 6(B)]: PROTOCOL APPROVAL; [ERC FORM 6(C)]: LETTER TEMPLATE FOR MODIFICATION or [ERC FORM 6(D)]: LETTER TEMPLATE FOR CLARIFICATION OR PI INTERVIEW

MANAGEMENT OF INCOMING AND OUTGOING COMMUNICATIONS

STUDY PROTOCOL COMMUNICATION RECORDS WORKFLOW

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Sort all communications	PSUREC Secretariat
Record all communications (ERC form 6I)	PSUREC Secretariat
Store all Communications	PSUREC Secretariat

STUDY PROTOCOL COMMUNICATION RECORDS PROCESS

ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBILITY
Sorting of all communications received and issued by the RIHS ERC	PSUREC Secretariat
Recording of the Details of the Communication	PSUREC Secretariat
Store Communication Records	PSUREC Secretariat
Disposal of Unnecessary Copies	PSUREC Secretariat
Maintaining the Active Files	PSUREC Secretariat

Sorting of all Communications received and Issued by the PSUREC

Communications can come in the form of letters, official memoranda, or emails.

The PSUREC Secretariat Staff sorts all communications received and prepares them for recording.

Unclaimed action letters will be filed in the respective study protocol folders.

Recording of the Details of the Communication

Study protocol-related communications received by the PSUREC are recorded in the [PSUREC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG. This form is updated as each submission is received.

Storage of Communication Records

The PSUREC Secretariat files a copy of the communication in the study file.

The PSUREC Secretariat then writes in the protocol folder contents index as each communication is filed.

Disposal of Unnecessary Copies

Guidelines and references that have been superseded or outdated for three (3) years are removed from the files and disposed of properly.

Removed document files are shredded and permanently deleted from electronic and physical files.

MANAGEMENT OF ACTIVE FILES

Maintaining the Active Study Files

Master file is the file comprising of all essential documents and correspondence related to the study/protocol. Trial master files should be established at the beginning of the trial, in the PSUREC Secretariat.

The approved study files are assigned unique identifiers (PSUREC Code.).

Gather, classify and combine all related documents together of the approved study files appropriately. Keep all active files in a secured file cabinet with controlled access. A log book of authorized individuals accessing the files will be maintained.

Keep all active files in a secured file cabinet with controlled access. A log book of authorized individuals accessing the files will be maintained.

Maintain the study files in an easily accessible and secure place for at least 3 years after the study closure.

All closed study files will be separately archived.

Final disposal of study/master files on completion of archival period.

ARCHIVING

Management of Archived Study Files

Archived study files are classified as either:

1. Study protocols with approved final reports, or
2. Approved study protocols declared INACTIVE by the ERC if no communication is received from the study team for a period of twelve (12) months
3. Study protocols for initial review with resubmissions beyond 90 days from date of action letter

Upon receipt of [PSUREC FORM 4(C)]: FINAL REPORT FORM, the ERC reviews it.

Upon approval of the [PSUREC FORM 4(C)]: FINAL REPORT FORM, the PSUREC Secretariat removes the contents of the entire file from the active study filing area and verifies that all documents are present in an organized manner.

Unnecessary copies are disposed of accordingly.

Only authorized PSUREC Secretariat staff can retrieve documents either from active files or from the archives.

MANAGEMENT OF ACCESS TO CONFIDENTIAL FILES

MANAGEMENT OF QUERIES AND COMPLAINTS

Receipt and Management of submitted queries or complaints

Queries and complaints, especially from research participants, are major considerations because they provide mechanisms that contribute both to maintaining transparency of PSUREC decision-making processes, as well as empowerment of study participants.

Action on queries and complaints is managed through the use of [PSUREC FORM 4(I)]: QUERIES OR COMPLAINT FORM. Each query or complaint received will be individually entered into this form by the PSUREC Secretariat for processing.

The PSUREC Secretariat logs the query or complaint into the [PSUREC FORM 6(I)]: SUBMISSIONS LOG.

Review of Study Protocol Related Participant Query or Complaint

The PSUREC Secretariat distributes the completed [PSUREC FORM 4(I)]: QUERIES OR COMPLAINT FORM to PSUREC Members along with the meeting agenda.

The PSUREC deliberates on how best to address the concerns relevant to the query or complaint, and recommends a course of action.

The PSUREC may request information from the Principal Investigator, invite the Principal Investigator for clarificatory interview or require corrective action.

WRITING AND REVISING SOPS